



Android 12 Beta

Beta Android accessibility feature uses facial expressions to control your phone.
<https://digit.in/sep21-69>



Microsoft Teams update

Microsoft Teams will soon protect you from pranksters and scammers.
<https://digit.in/sep21-70>

Realme Buds Wireless 2

Value for money entry-level active noise cancelling earbuds

Realme is pushing towards bringing premium features to their audio portfolio, at an affordable price so that the masses can benefit from them. They have launched multiple audio products that adhere to this philosophy. Now, Realme has launched its latest neckband style wireless earphone – the Realme Buds Wireless 2 that come with an array of features for the lowly price of ₹2,299. Let's find out if it's worth your money.

BUILD AND COMFORT

The Realme Buds Wireless 2 is available in two colours – Bass Gray and Bass Yellow. The build quality is pretty decent for the price. The neckband is smooth and velvety to the touch but feels robust. It is also very flexible.

The modules or weights on the side feel slightly cheap and plasticky. The left weight module has nothing on it while the right one houses the buttons and the USB-C charging port. There are four buttons in total – Volume up, Volume down, ANC toggle and a Multi-function button.

The earbuds are simple and have a glossy and matte dual finish. They are angled slightly to help with fit. The buds can attach to each other magnetically and the action of attaching them turns them off and detaching them powers them on. Simply detaching the buds from each other, powers the device on, and connects instantaneously to a paired device.

The neckband weighs 29g and is very comfortable to wear over long periods of time. The buds are also rated IPX5 for protection against sweat and water. So, they can be used in the gym or while exercising without a worry.

FEATURES

The Realme Buds Wireless 2 is an extremely feature-laden pair of wireless earphones. Seeing that it is priced



very aggressively at ₹2,299, this makes these earphones an excellent value for money choice for users. The Buds Wireless 2 come with Active Noise Cancellation that can allegedly offer noise reduction up to 25dB.

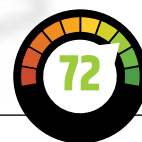
In our tests, we found the Active Noise Cancellation performance to be pretty decent, it works decently enough to cancel out some of the low-frequency, constant sounds such as an AC hum. The buds also come with Transparency mode that works adequately well.

The Realme Buds Wireless 2 is supported by the Realme Link app that allows users to tweak some aspects of the earphone. You can customise the controls as per your requirements within the app. You can also use the app to toggle between noise cancellation modes – Noise Cancellation, Normal and Transparency. There's also an option to toggle between some preset EQ profiles such as Bass Boost+, Dynamic, and Bright as per your preferences. Apart from these functions, you can check the battery percentage of your earphones, perform firmware updates, enter game mode and more within the app.

PERFORMANCE

The Realme Buds Wireless 2 is powered by the R2 chip and comes with

Bluetooth 5.0 for connectivity. The buds feature large 13.6mm bass boost drivers with support for SBC, AAC and Sony's LDAC hi-res codec. The Realme Buds Wireless 2 has a V-shaped sound signature with boosted bass and highs. Thanks to the large driver, you get loud thumping bass that sounds dynamic and energetic. The low bass is boosted and it can mask the sounds in the upper bass and mids by bleeding into them. There's also a fair amount of sibilance and shrillness due to the boosted highs. Turning on the LDAC codec does improve the sound considerably.



BUILD	76
FEATURES	85
PERFORMANCE	66
VALUE	80

BATTERY LIFE

Realme claims that the Realme Buds Wireless 2 come with a battery playtime of a whopping 22 hours with ANC turned off, and 18 hours with ANC turned on. We put the Realme Buds Wireless 2 through its paces to test out battery life and we're pleased to

say that the buds delivered. At 70 per cent volume with ANC turned on, the buds provided 17 hours and 5 minutes of playtime, which is not too far away from the company estimate.

VERDICT

If you're scouring the market for an inexpensive pair of wireless earbuds with perks such as ANC, app support, good battery life, and more, the Realme Buds Wireless 2 is a very compelling option. It is one of the most, if not the most, feature-rich wireless earphones in this price range. At ₹2,299, there's very little to criticise about the Realme Buds Wireless 2.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

COLOURS: Bass Yellow, Bass Gray | NOISE CANCELLATION: ANC + Vocplus AI Noise cancellation for calls | BATTERY LIFE: 22 hours with ANC on, 18 hours with ANC on | CHARGING TIME: 50 minutes | AUDIO CODECS: LDAC, AAC, SBC | BLUETOOTH VERSION: 5.0 | DRIVER SIZE: 13.6mm | BLUETOOTH RANGE: 33 feet | IP RATING: IPX5

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